

interest, they would swap ideas. These folks passed on many ideas to father over the decades. Yet he was so clear in what he wanted, relative to the fifteen points, and so focused to do nothing else, that in his entire career he essentially only followed any one man into a stock once. Other ideas from that same person he brushed off because they were never quite good enough in his mind— not quite right.

He followed the thinking of two particular individuals twice. One of the two had ideas that were money losers both times. The only person he ever followed three times was me. He adopted three of my stock ideas fully across his client base and for him and my mother and made more than a thousand percent on each of them. Those were the most ideas he ever adopted from any one person, ever, and he did well with all of them; mine all came in the mid-to-later-1970's, late in his career, which, as I've already told you, was a time when his successes were thin-ning and should have been, therefore, doubly precious.

But let me show you who he was. Of those three stock ideas, two he never acknowledged to me. The third? More than fifteen years later, in my forties, he sent me a short note to tell me I had done well with it—he owned it still then and years later. When I recalled the other two ideas to him, he acknowledged them but no further. No congratulations. No thank you. Because I was always less fearful of him than others were, I verbally kicked at him a bit at times, which I did then, asking who else had he ever gotten three successful investment ideas from. He pointed out to me that there was no one, but that wasn't so important. The key was in him, he explained, in knowing which ideas to follow and which to discard and that he hadn't followed any of my bad ideas. That annoyed me. So, I retorted that he had followed plenty of other people's bad ideas, and then he got mad at me and we didn't speak for about a month. Then he forgot he was ever mad at me, and the subject never came up again. That was who he was: cool, cold, hard, tough, disciplined, non-social, never quitting, ever confident externally but internally often scared. And amazing. I know he respected me; but to the people he respected most, he had the hardest time communicating that directly.

What was his daily grind like? In 1958, as *Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits* was published, Father arrived home from work in the late afternoon, changed clothes, ate dinner with the family formally in the dining room,